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15-minute train to O'Hare pitched

Aspirational plan for trip from Loop is yet to secure agreements

By **Talia Soglin**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A group of business and transportation leaders wants to build a private train they say could take travelers from downtown Chicago to O'Hare International Airport in 15 minutes, but the project would need to clear significant planning, financial and regulatory hurdles to get rolling.

The aspirational plan, called the O'Hare Flyer, would rely on the use of freight railroad tracks to shuttle travelers between downtown and the airport. Leaders of the initiative would not disclose ticket prices, but said the trip would cost “significantly” less than a taxi or rideshare but more than a trip on the Chicago Transit Authority’s Blue Line. Trains would run every 15 minutes from 4 a.m. until 10 p.m.

The CEO of the initiative is Dave Lundy, a lobbyist and the CEO of strategic communications firm Aileron Communications. The group’s leadership also includes rail industry veteran Mark Walbrun and Kristi Lafleur, a former executive director of the Illinois Tollway. The project, which could be ready to launch within five years, would cost about \$2.25 billion and would be entirely privately funded, the group said, emphasizing they would not be seeking government subsidies for the plan.

The group pitched the express train as a mode that would add speed and comfort to the trip between downtown and O'Hare, which takes around 45 minutes and costs between \$2.50 and \$5 on the CTA’s Blue Line.

“O'Hare (is a) world-class airport, or will be when Terminal 2 is built,” Lundy said, referencing the city’s ongoing, massive modernization project at the airport. “Chicago is a world-class city. What we have lacked is a world-class way

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Students are welcomed on a red carpet by teachers, staff and parents on the first day of school on Monday at Leland Elementary in Chicago’s Austin neighborhood. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘FINALLY, TODAY IS THE FIRST DAY’

Chicago Public Schools students, families get back to the daily routine

By **Kate Armanini, Darcel Rockett and Kate Perez**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Across the city Monday morning, yellow school buses zipped through streets. Throngs of children in uniform filed into school buildings. Teachers, crossing guards and school staff greeted familiar faces and new ones as students arrived for the first day of class.

More than 300,000 students headed back to class across the city as Chicago Public Schools opened its doors for the 2026-27 school year. For many, it was a welcome return.

Sarai Ellis — whose 9-year-old loves basketball and football — said her family was ready for summer to come to an end.

“He’s a very outdoorsy person.

I’ll be wanting to relax and he’ll be like, ‘Mom, can we go outside?’ And I’m like, ‘We were just outside all day,’” Ellis, 29, said with a laugh. “So we’re excited to go back.”

The first day comes as the district faces serious financial uncertainty. CPS is considered only 70% funded under the state’s funding formula. To put pressure on lawmakers, the school board approved a budget in July that includes \$150 million in unconfirmed state money. District leaders warned the move could lead to midyear cuts if the funds don’t materialize.

More than 700 teachers were laid off earlier this summer to help close a \$732 million deficit. The revised budget directed CPS leaders to restore those positions

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Liam Moran, 9, brushes his teeth at his home in Roseland before his first day of fourth grade at Tarkington Elementary School on Monday. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Volunteers offer aid to Calumet Township

Meals, portable toilets provided amid power outage, sewage issues

By **Maya Wilkins**
POST-TRIBUNE

Nearly two weeks after the Aug. 11 derecho hit northwest Indiana, Calumet Township resident Pam Oliver got power and sewage restored Sunday night.

“I celebrated by flushing the toilet like four times,” Oliver said. “I had to make sure it was real.”

Although Oliver’s power is restored, other residents of Calumet Township, which is located just south of Gary’s city limits, are still going without it because a recently installed sewage system only works



Volunteers organize a table with drinks, snacks, clothing and other supplies as locals, in partnership with the World Central Kitchen, distribute goods to those impacted by the outages in the region on Monday. **KYLE TELECHAN/FOR THE POST-TRIBUNE**

when power is on. While they wait for power, volunteers in the area are providing meals, water and portable showers and toilets.

Tim Kuiper, chairman of the board of the Lake Ridge Fire Protection District, said the fire station, located at 2301 47th Ave.

in Gary, has portable showers and toilets for Calumet Township residents.

“When you have no power, you can’t make coffee, you can’t brush your teeth, you can’t take a shower,”

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Trade feud between US, Canada escalates

Northern neighbors will levy retaliatory tariffs against nation

By **Rob Gillies**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

TORONTO — Canada will announce retaliatory tariffs against the United States on Tuesday, an official familiar with the plans told The Associated Press, escalating a trade fight that has sharply worsened since negotiations with the Trump administration collapsed.

The official spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to discuss the plans publicly.

Prime Minister Mark Carney said Monday that Canada may need to move away from matching U.S. tariffs dollar for dollar and instead use more targeted retaliation, saying officials were

reviewing options aimed at protecting Canadian workers and businesses.

President Donald Trump escalated the dispute again Monday, telling Canadian leaders to “fall in line” or face consequences “far WORSE” than tariffs already imposed and threatening new 50% tariffs on Canadian vehicles, auto parts and steel.

Carney said U.S. trade demands had confirmed Canada’s fears that Washington was seeking to dismantle major Canadian industries. Nonetheless, he said Canada remained willing to negotiate, but only if the United States approached the talks as a partnership between sovereign countries.

“An attitude at the negotiation table that Canada is a subsidiary of the United States” is “not something we’re going to accept,”

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Payton coming to The Score

Veteran anchor and son of Bears great Walter Payton chosen to replace Mike “Mully” Mulligan for morning show at Chicago sports talk radio station. **Business**

New round of sanctions on Iran

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced new sanctions and warned every country that does business with Iran to sever ties or face retaliation. **Nation & World**

What Sox need for stretch run

Consistency from Munetaka Murakami, Colson Montgomery will be crucial for the Sox to get where they ultimately want to go. **Sports**

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